The Quiet Rewrite

Four months of terms, data and consent | Apple, Dropbox, Evernote, Microsoft; Runbox and mailbox.org follow-up
Review window: June 25-October 25, 2026 | Prepared October 25, 2026

A cloud account can keep the same name while the bargain beneath it changes. This compact record follows changes in who may process information, who may interrupt access, and how users can challenge a decision.

Finding: There are material changes worth examining, but the dates do not support a four-company response to Fifty Milliseconds Before Consent. Its OSF project became public on September 2. Two reviewed revisions were announced earlier. [S1-S3, S7]

Company	What deserves attention	Relation to September 2
Dropbox	Shorter free-account inactivity period; linked-account consequences; new age signals and admin visibility.	Posted September 1: before. Effective January 1, 2027.
Evernote	Removed general consent assurance; explicit analytics and advertising rules; stronger AI no-training promise.	October 1 update: after. December 1 for existing users.
Apple	Recovered baseline confirms added over-quota deletion clause and refusal-of-update access warning.	September 14 revision: after. Compared with August 29 archive.
Microsoft	Changed U.S. arbitration provider and related-case process. Examined content/AI permissions already existed.	Published July 30: before. Effective September 30.

Mail-service follow-up: Runbox's archived Boxy notice excludes user-message logging; today's notice includes it and AI review. The change date is unresolved. Mailbox.org's main privacy notice matches its June archive. See pages 8-9. [S24-S25, S31-S32]

What the evidence supports

The strongest retention changes are Dropbox's halved inactivity interval and Apple's new over-quota deletion clause. Evernote removes a general new-purpose consent assurance, adds tracking rules, and strengthens the AI no-training promise. These are contract and privacy-policy changes; the sources do not establish unauthorized disclosure or a response to the investigation. [S2-S8, S10-S17, S19, S21-S23]

Evidence grades throughout: direct comparison; provider-described change; current wording with unverified novelty. No emails were sent and no accounts or policies were changed.

Put publication before inference

Announcement, revision, effective date and archive capture are different events.

Date	Documented event	Timing
February 11	Evernote January terms captured; full tracker text recovered and its published hash reproduced. [S17, S20]	Earlier comparison
July 30	Microsoft publishes the new Services Agreement. [S7-S9]	34 calendar days before
June 24 / August 29	Complete Evernote January policy captured / Apple September 2025 terms archived. [S15, S21]	Before
September 1	Dropbox posts upcoming terms and privacy policy. [S3, S5]	1 day before
September 2	OSF project 69hga is made public. [S1]	Comparison anchor
September 3 / 14	Evernote mirror changes only footer URLs, not policy text / Apple dates iCloud revision. [S12, S22]	1 / 12 days after
September 30	Microsoft’s July agreement takes effect. [S7]	Effective date only
October 1 / 2	Evernote dates revised policy / Open Terms Archive records substantive changes at 00:37:52 UTC. [S10, S23]	29 / 30 days after
December 1 / January 1	Evernote existing-user transition / Dropbox effective date. [S3, S6]	Future at review date

The publication anchor is an event, not a filename

The live OSF log identifies action **made_public**, project **69hga**, event **6a97cebe7b4afb6618d61304**, and timestamp **2026-09-02T07:22:38.889947** (API string as returned). The October 21 backup agrees. Registration c8fb6 records September 2 at 07:58:01.244169. The project-public event is the anchor used here. [S1]

Calendar-day offsets use date labels, not purported exact intervals between publication times. A matching date sequence cannot identify awareness, motive, coordination or the date a policy was drafted.

Access can fail across accounts

Direct comparison: January 7, 2025 terms versus September 1, 2026 posting, effective January 1, 2027. Privacy baseline: May 30, 2025. [S2-S5]

Issue	Earlier wording / rule	Upcoming wording / rule
Free-account inactivity	12 consecutive months without access.	6 consecutive months: half the interval. Notice and an opportunity to remedy/export remain.
Age restriction	13 in the U.S.; 16 elsewhere, subject to higher local requirements.	18; enforcement may use third-party information, including app-store age signals.
Linked access	No equivalent linked-workspace paragraph in the compared text.	Action against one account may affect other accounts sharing its email address.
Admin visibility	Team-admin control and access were already disclosed.	Admins may see state changes in other accounts using the same email address.

Two small phrases, substantial consequences

Earlier: “12 consecutive months.” Upcoming: “6 consecutive months.” [S2-S3]

These are concrete account-retention and access risks for dormant research collections. The added privacy sentence also makes cross-account status visibility explicit. It does not say admins can read every unrelated account’s files. [S3, S5]

What did not become new

The feature-related permission to scan stored content and involve affiliates or trusted third parties appears in both versions. AI and machine-learning references also exist in the earlier privacy policy. The current FAQ describes service improvement and some manual review, but this comparison does not date those practices to September. [S2-S5, S18]

Exact locators: Terms / Termination; Your Responsibilities; Your Accounts; Dropbox Teams. Privacy / With Whom / Team Admins. Raw before/after snapshots and normalized differences are included. The posting predates the OSF publication anchor.

Consent has a longer shadow

Complete January policy recovered twice: June 24 Wayback capture and September 3 repository snapshot. Their extracted policy bodies match exactly. Compared with the October 1 policy. [S10, S21-S23]

Issue	Earlier policy	October policy
Unspecified new purposes	Express promise to request consent before using data for a purpose absent from the policy.	That sentence is absent. This removes an explicit assurance; it does not establish that an undisclosed use occurred.
First-party analytics	Main policy refers readers to a separate Cookie Notice; no equivalent analytics-exemption sentence.	Expressly treats some first-party analytics as technical trackers without consent where lawful; contact-based opt-out remains.
Consent withdrawal	No equivalent processing-after-withdrawal paragraph in this main policy.	Further collection stops, but previously collected data may still be processed where law permits.
Advertising	Personalized advertising and related consent already described.	Adds explicit non-personalized advertising using limited data, such as country/language, under legitimate interests.
Browser signals	States it does not act on Do Not Track.	Adds recognition of legally applicable GPC opt-outs for targeted-advertising sale/sharing. GPC and DNT are different signals.

The strongest newly verified omission

> “We’ll ask for your consent before using your personal data for a purpose not described in this Privacy Policy.” [S21-S22]

The complete October text lacks that assurance. The main-policy additions on analytics and retained data are also directly verifiable. Earlier tracking itself is not new: the old policy disclosed cookies, usage collection, advertising and a separate Cookie Notice. [S10, S21-S22]

Exact sections: How do we use your data?; How do we use cookies and similar technologies?; How do we respond to browser-based privacy signals? Numbered full-policy extracts and a local redline are preserved. The earlier separate Cookie Notice was located but not recovered, so the first appearance of these rules across all incorporated documents remains unverified.

AI promises and access boundaries

The full comparison separates training, ordinary processing, human access and third-party connections. [S10, S21-S23]

Issue	Earlier policy	October policy
Training	AI input/output excluded from training unless the user directs otherwise.	Removes that exception; expressly extends the no-training statement to third-party model providers.
Built-in AI processing	AI mentioned alongside improvement of the service; supplemental terms referenced.	Dedicated section explains input/output processing, contracted providers and account controls to manage or disable AI.
User-connected services	Voluntary third-party access required notice/agreement; external policies applied.	Specifically distinguishes connected Claude/ChatGPT from Evernote's AI providers. Their own policies govern.
Human access to notes	Permission or legal necessity required; support/review permissions described.	The full section on human access is unchanged, including permission and legal-necessity limits.

Independent copies, matching text

The 5,004-word older main policy is available as archived HTML and an independent repository copy. Their extracted policy text has the same SHA-256. The September 3 commit changed only seven footer links to regional URLs. The October 2 commit records the substantive revision; the current page says October 1. These are capture and revision dates, not evidence of motive. [S21-S23]

The agreement changes remain separate

Evernote's official notice transfers the service contract to Bending Spoons Operations S.p.A.; the January terms already named that Italian company as software owner. October terms also make human/automated investigations and temporary blocking explicit, while earlier terms already permitted suspension and removal. [S6, S11, S17]

Exact AI locators: old How do we use your data? / Maintain and improve the Services; current What data is processed when you use an Evernote AI Feature? Human access: Would someone at Evernote ever view your Content? Local verification records identical human-access text. This replaces the earlier dossier's incomplete-privacy-policy limitation.

The storage ceiling becomes a deadline

Direct comparison: September 15, 2025 terms captured August 29, 2026 versus September 14, 2026 terms. Same U.S.-English URL. [S12, S15]

Clause	Recovered September 2025 terms	September 2026 terms
I.C / Over quota	Exceeding limits could stop backups, documents and incoming email; repeated violations could terminate access.	Adds explicit deletion of stored data exceeding the limit after 30 days' notice.
I.E / Updates	Material-adverse-change notice and paid-term protections, with exceptions.	Retains those protections; adds that refusing agreement updates may cause loss of service access.
II.G.6 / iCloud+	No Apple Intelligence feature clause in this baseline.	Adds Apple Intelligence, including Siri AI, with potential usage limits.
Opening / Scope	Governs iCloud product, software, services and websites.	Explicitly includes use of the Apple Account.

A specific expansion, not the first deletion power

Earlier clauses already allowed deletion following failed payment, account termination and 180 days without a device backup. The new I.C sentence expressly ties deletion to excess storage. It does not identify which files would be selected or their order. [S12, S15]

Dates that can now be checked

Wayback returned the full archived page with **Memento-Datetime: August 29, 2026, 17:58:47 GMT** and the original Apple response date one second later. The archived text is revised September 15, 2025. The current revision is twelve calendar days after the September 2 OSF event; that sequence does not establish causation. [S1, S12, S15]

Separate privacy issue: Apple documents Private Relay IP disclosure, CVE-2026-65352, fixed in the August 17 release; the bulletin entry was added September 14. The cited entry does not establish exploitation. [S14]

Preserved: original compressed archive response, decoded HTML, text, response headers, exact source URLs and a local redline. The earlier failed June replay is superseded by this successful August recovery. No login, account change or contact with Apple was needed.

The change is in the remedy

Published July 30, 2026; effective September 30, 2026. Earlier comparison: official 2025 agreement. [S7-S9]

Provision	2025 agreement	2026 agreement / change
Content license	Service-related worldwide, royalty-free permission appears in section 2.b, PDF page 3.	The examined permission remains. It is not newly introduced in this four-month window.
AI input/output	Processing and storage for abuse prevention already appears in section 14.s.v, PDF page 26.	The examined wording remains in section 14.s.v.
U.S. arbitration	AAA under the earlier provisions.	JAMS replaces AAA for arbitrations initiated after effectiveness; related cases include a mediation step.
Coverage	Earlier introductory scope referred to the listed services.	Introduction includes products, websites and services referring to the agreement.

Why it matters

Changing a dispute forum and procedures affects how customers pursue claims. The official summary also clarifies Copilot coverage and product naming. These are substantive contract observations, but the reviewed changes do not establish a new right to use all private documents for AI training. [S7-S9]

The timing cuts against a later-response theory

July 30 is 34 calendar days before the September 2 OSF publication event. September 30 is an effective date, not evidence that the agreement was first conceived or announced after the investigation. [S1, S7-S8]

Earlier PDF page numbers are one-based. The official 37-page PDF was readable through the web retrieval service, while direct download returned HTTP 403. This packet therefore contains labeled parsed excerpts and source links, not a claimed original binary copy. Current agreement and change-summary captures are likewise labeled.

A bounded conclusion

The useful record is specific: shorter dormancy, interconnected accounts, changing contractual parties, AI-provider boundaries and altered dispute procedures. Evidence of a coordinated response, covert access or a breach would require additional records. This review did not find those records.

The chat now leaves a record

Direct comparison of Boxy privacy disclosures: May 19, 2026 archive versus October 25 retrieval. This is the optional support chatbot, not a new mailbox-wide Terms of Service. [S24-S25]

Issue	Archived Boxy notice	Current Boxy notice
User messages	Explicitly excluded from Runbox logs and retention.	Both sides logged; user messages sanitized before storage. Legitimate interests stated as the basis.
Retention	Bot replies retained for 30 days in Norway.	Conversation logs retained for 10 days in Norway; authorized staff access.
AI providers and routing	Anthropic/Claude; U.S. processing under SCCs; Cloudflare described as intermediary.	Lists Mistral AI, Scaleway, OnshoreAI and TensorX; direct API calls from Norway. Mojeek supplies search.
Further processing	No equivalent daily log-review or translation disclosure in the recovered notice.	Mistral screens messages and reviews sanitized logs daily; staff may request translation. Providers described as not training on messages.

A real disclosure change, with an unresolved start date

The scope of retained chatbot data is broader even though the stated retention period is shorter. Added processing purposes and a different provider list deserve notice. A full comparison and numbered extracts are preserved. The sources do not show when each feature was deployed. [S24-S25]

The public explanations do not agree

The still-live May 6 article says user messages are never retained; the current Boxy policy expressly includes them. The October 8 general AI policy still describes logging bot responses, without explaining the newer two-sided logging and daily review. This is a documented disclosure inconsistency. [S25-S27]

Exact locators: older How Boxy works / What happens to your messages; current What is logged and why / What happens to your messages / Web search. No evidence here shows Boxy accessing a mailbox or research attachment, or links this revision to the author’s investigation. The general AI policy says Boxy has no account or email access. [S26]

The dates set the boundary

A changed chatbot notice is established. A rapid mailbox-wide data-rights expansion is not established for either provider.

Mailbox.org: the recovered baseline holds

The complete English data-protection notice archived on June 15 at 05:08:25 UTC matches the October 25 policy text exactly after navigation is excluded: 6,243 words, including all sections through the January 27, 2026 version date. The matching text and SHA-256 are saved. [S31-S32]

Its summer announcement changes Standard/Premium prices and storage, effective July 15 for new private customers and September 1 for existing customers. It expressly leaves Light unchanged. That announcement does not add rights to read mail or train AI. The full general-terms body also matches an August 27 archive exactly: 5,464 words covering withdrawal, prepaid and business provisions. These matched snapshots do not exclude an intermediate revision that was later reverted. [S33-S35]

Date / source	What it establishes	What it cannot establish
May 19 / S24	Archived Boxy notice: no user-message logs.	This baseline falls before the four-month window.
August 17 / S28	Support migration ends users’ access to old tickets; open enquiries continue.	Does not establish backend deletion or data disclosure.
September 2 / S1	The OSF investigation becomes public.	Does not date the Boxy policy change.
October 8 / S26	General AI policy carries this update date, corroborated by page metadata.	Does not date every Boxy feature or change.
October 18 / S25	Boxy response reports Last-Modified 11:50:02 GMT.	Server-supplied metadata is not proof of first publication.
October 25 / S25	Current two-sided logging and daily review wording retrieved.	Does not prove deployment, affected users or motivation.

Runbox’s core privacy and service terms still display April 2018 update dates. Their older archive replays were unavailable in this review; those displayed dates alone cannot prove unchanged wording. The verified addition is the Boxy comparison, with its narrower scope and dating limits. [S29-S30]

Enough to audit, small enough to keep

Every source below is linked. Receipts and SHA-256 checksums identify the local copies; hashes establish local integrity, not the truth of a policy's assertions.

S1 OSF made-public log; 69hga / Sept 2

S2 Dropbox terms / Jan 7, 2025

S3 Dropbox upcoming terms / Sept 1, 2026

S4 Dropbox privacy / May 30, 2025

S5 Dropbox upcoming privacy / Sept 1, 2026

S6 Evernote transition notice / Oct 1, 2026

S7 Microsoft agreement / July 30, 2026

S8 Microsoft official change summary / 2026

S9 Microsoft prior agreement / 2025, pp. 3, 26

S10 Evernote privacy / Oct 1, 2026

S11 Evernote terms / Oct 1, 2026

S12 Apple iCloud terms / Sept 14, 2026

S13 Apple Siri AI launch / Sept 14, 2026

S14 Apple Tahoe 26.6.2 security bulletin / WebKit

S15 Apple Sept 2025 terms / archived Aug 29, 2026

S16 Evernote privacy excerpt / captured Aug 13, 2026

S17 Evernote Jan 2026 full terms / tracker version 1558

S18 Dropbox privacy FAQ / current context, undated here

S19 Evernote privacy redline / Aug 13-Oct 5 captures

S20 Evernote Feb 11 Wayback / parsed corroboration

S21 Evernote complete January policy / June 24 archive

S22 Evernote complete policy / September 3 mirror

S23 Evernote policy changes / October 2 commit

The mail-policy record

Historical and current notices, provider announcements and the limits of each comparison.

S24 Boxy older privacy notice / archived May 19, 2026

S25 Boxy privacy notice / retrieved October 25, 2026

S26 Runbox general AI policy / October 8, 2026

S27 Runbox Boxy article / May 6, still live October 25

S28 Runbox support migration / August 17, 2026

S29 Runbox core privacy policy / dated April 25, 2018

S30 Runbox service terms / dated April 24, 2018

S31 Mailbox.org privacy / archived June 15, 2026

S32 Mailbox.org privacy / retrieved October 25, 2026

S33 Mailbox.org general terms / current, matching August archive

S34 Mailbox.org price/storage announcement / July 15, 2026

S35 Mailbox.org full general terms / August 27 archive

Preservation and limits

Sources contains compressed original HTTP bodies where retrieved, readable text extracts, response receipts and parsed web captures where direct downloads failed. SOURCE_INDEX.json maps the numbered references to files and URLs. SHA256SUMS.txt covers every deliverable except itself. SNAPSHOTS.html provides short before/after cards without opening raw captures.

Recovery update: Apple’s earlier terms and Evernote’s earlier main privacy policy are complete. S21-S23 supersede the partial privacy recovery in S16/S19. The older separate Cookie Notice remains unavailable; newly explicit main-policy wording does not date the start of actual tracking. No comprehensive breach-history finding is claimed.